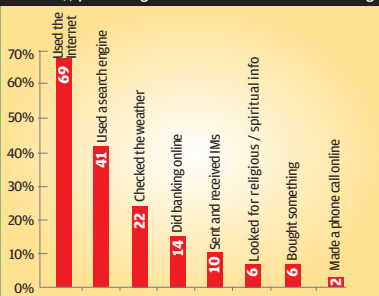


STAT ATTACK

On a typical day (over 2006 and 2007; source: Pew Internet), percentage of users who did the following:



The average Internet user is 46.6 years old. 71% of senior (above 65) Internet users have received a video link, and 50% of them have forwarded links.

Source: Pew Internet, July 2007

End of 2007, traffic from Macs accounted for 8 per cent of Web traffic. Windows use fell in the past year.

One in six British pounds is now spent online. Internet shopping in the UK in 2007 was 50% higher than in 2006

As of January 2008, 48% of internet users had been to video-sharing sites. Traffic to such sites has doubled in the past year

examining and probing the data. The site will also include YouTube-style commenting and annotating features, which will allow for quicker sorting of information. This will allow for making massive data sets—like all the images from the Hubble Space Telescope—accessible to the public.

So how will all this data be uploaded to Google? In a post by a Science Foo attendee, the collection plan was described thus: “(They) are providing a 3 TB drive array (Linux RAID5). The array is provided in ‘suitcase’ and shipped to anyone who

wants to send they data to Google. Anyone interested gives Google the file tree, and they SLURP the data off the drive. I believe they can extend this to a larger array (my memory says 20 TB).”

GEOGRAPHY WITH A CAUSE

Geotagging Adds Value To Images

Did you imagine it possible to find the location, altitude, latitude, and longitude of a

picture just by looking at it? It is, now. The act of entering this metadata is called geotagging; it is becoming increasingly popular as more and more users start to upload their photos online.

When users upload their photos to Flickr or Picasa, they have an option to enter the name of the place where the photos were taken. When you run a search with that location name, your uploaded photos will also be displayed. Thanks to geotagging, it is now possible to search for almost anything accurately. Recently, mountaineers have been using geotagging to enter the altitude at which photos were taken with the help of GPS receivers. These photographs allow other mountaineers to determine the mountain surface at various altitudes.

This is just one of the examples of the advantages of geotagging; there have been reports of professional bird-watchers using it to keep track of the migratory paths of birds and drawing a path based on the location of the geotagged images.

The only hindrance to more detailed geotagging currently is that it involves fiddling with another device like a GPS receiver or a computer after the photographs are taken. Flickr estimates that only 5 per cent of their photos have simple geotags on them. However, camera makers are toying with the

idea of including GPS receivers in the cameras, which will automatically geotag every image with details like latitude, longitude, and altitude.

GOOGLE WHAT?

“Google Generation” Not Too Good At It

A new study conducted by the British Library and the Joint Information Systems Committee dispels the myth that those born after 1993 are capable of using the Internet much more effectively and that they are generally better at gathering information from the medium.

Based on log analysis from British Library Web sites and search tools, the committee studies the books rented out by kids based on search engines as their referring links. The study claims that this new generation is neither better nor worse than those in the last 30 years. However, it does note some serious changes in today’s knowledge culture.

The study notes that since knowledge is primarily sought from Wikipedia or Google, there is no real “expert” these days. The only knowledge that exists is peer knowledge, found mostly on online communities. It also

MacBook Air



One of Apple’s best-kept secrets thus far, the company says the MacBook Air is the “world’s thinnest notebook” at 1.93 centimetres. The standard-configuration MacBook Air sports a 14-inch LED screen, an 80 GB PATA drive, a 1.6 GHz Intel Core 2 Duo, 2 GB of DDR2 SDRAM soldered to the logic board, 802.11 a/n, inbuilt camera, microphone, and speaker, and Bluetooth. The battery life is around five hours.

There is no Ethernet port, but users can purchase a USB-to-Gigabit Ethernet converter. This is the first

MacBook since the PowerBook 2400—which was released in May 2007—to ship without a CD/DVD drive. However, users can use share the disc drive off other computers wirelessly, or buy the external USB SuperDrive from Apple.

The notebook’s aluminium case engages a magnetic latch when being closed. The trackpad on the keyboard includes multi-touch features, which is an advancement over other models. The MacBook Air ships for \$1,799 (Rs 72,000), but will not be available in India anytime soon.

Buzzword of the Month